



narRater

Installation Guide

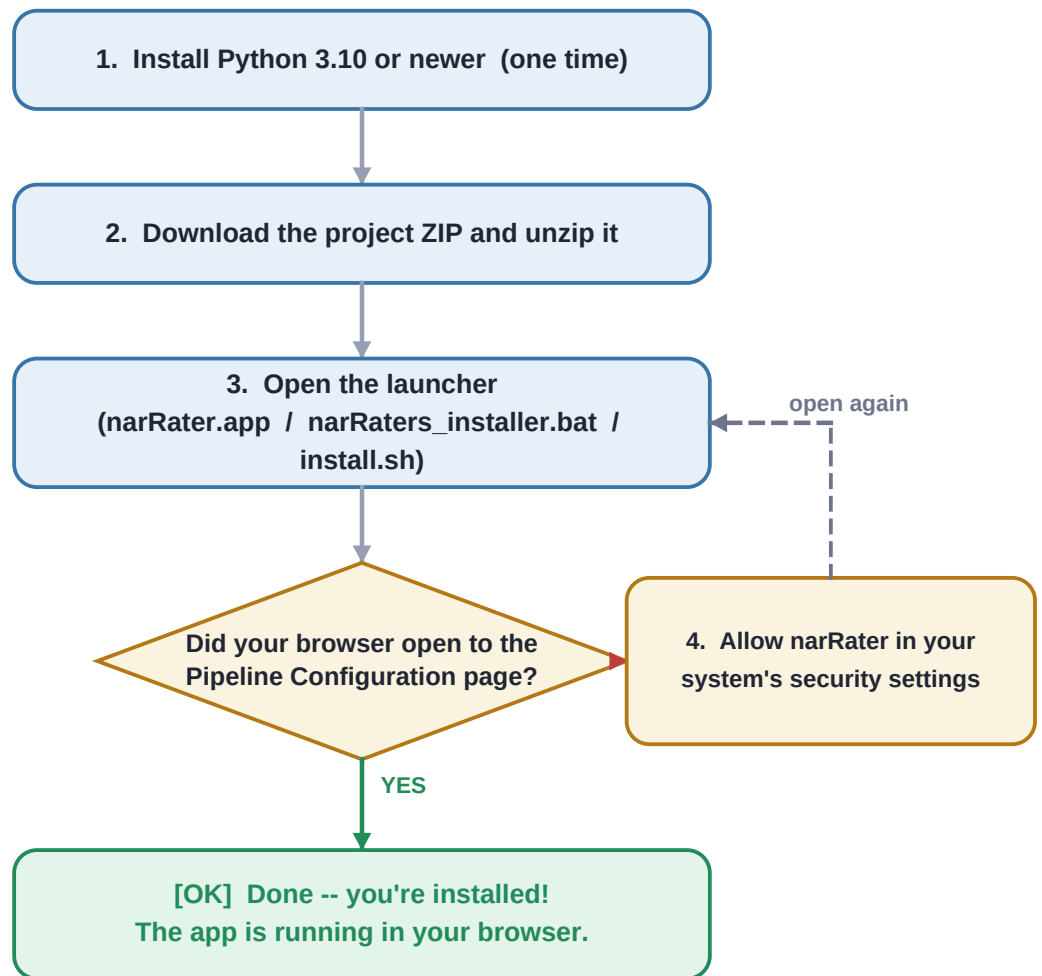
Get the app running on macOS, Windows, or Linux -- step by step, including how to clear the security prompt for unsigned research software.

You are installing research software from an independent developer.

It is not signed by Apple or Microsoft, so the first launch may be blocked by a security prompt. That is expected and safe to allow -- this guide shows exactly how. You only do the security step once.

How installation works (at a glance)

The whole process is five short steps. Most people finish in a couple of minutes. If the app is blocked the first time, you allow it once in your system's security settings and open it again -- then you are done.



The only step that ever varies by computer is Step 4 (security).

Steps 1-3 and the success screen are the same everywhere. Section "If the app won't open" covers macOS and Windows separately.

Before you start: Python 3.10+

narRater runs on Python. You need version 3.10 or newer (one-time install). To check what you have, open a terminal (macOS: Terminal app; Windows: Command Prompt) and run:

```
python3 --version      # macOS / Linux
python --version       # Windows
```

If it prints 3.10.x or higher, you're set. If it errors or shows an older version, install Python from python.org/downloads.

Windows: tick "Add python.exe to PATH".

In the Python installer, enable "Add python.exe to PATH" on the first screen before clicking Install. Without it, Windows can't find Python when the launcher runs.

Step 1 - Download the project and unzip it

On the GitHub page (github.com/xianNeuro/narRaters), click the green "Code" button, then "Download ZIP". Unzip the downloaded file. You'll get a folder named narRaters-main (or narRaters-0.3.x).

<> Code v

Clone

Download ZIP

Click Code, then Download ZIP. Unzip to get the narRaters folder.

Step 2 - Open the launcher

Open the unzipped folder and start the app for your system:

- macOS: double-click `narRater.app`
- Windows: double-click `narRaters_installer.bat`
- Linux: in a terminal, `cd` into the folder and run `bash install.sh`

The first launch sets things up and then opens your web browser automatically. If it opens to the Pipeline Configuration page, skip ahead to "Success". If nothing opens or you see a security warning, do the next section once.



The narRater.app launcher icon (macOS).

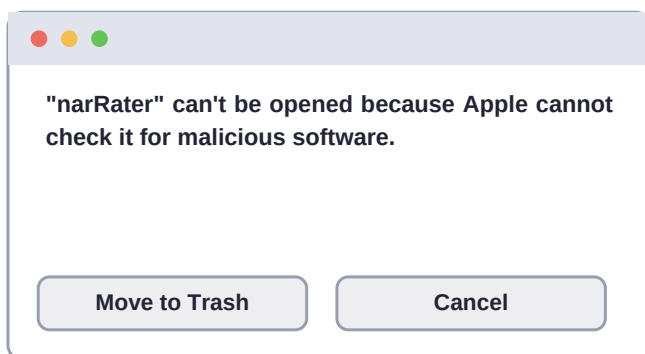
If the app won't open (security prompt)

Because narRater isn't signed by Apple or Microsoft, the first launch can be blocked. This is normal for independent research software. Allow it once, then open it again.

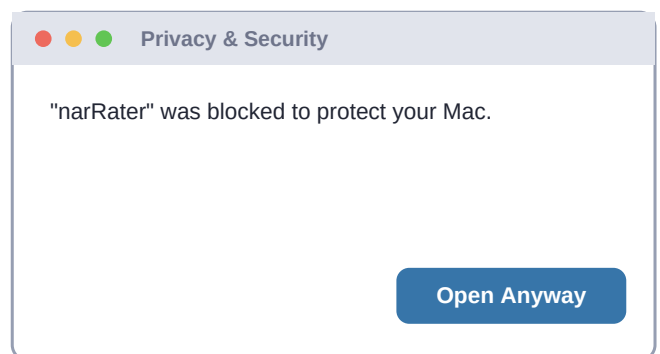
macOS

You may see a message like "narRater can't be opened because Apple cannot check it for malicious software." Use whichever of these works -- A is easiest:

- A. In Finder, control-click (or right-click) narRater.app -> Open, then click Open in the dialog that appears.
- B. Open System Settings -> Privacy & Security, scroll down, and click "Open Anyway" next to the narRater message (then enter your password).
- C. Still stuck (or the folder was quarantined)? In Terminal run: `xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine /path/to/narRaters-main` -- then try A again.



What you see first (just Cancel this).



The fix: click Open Anyway, then Open.

Windows

You may see a blue "Windows protected your PC" SmartScreen box. The "Run anyway" button is hidden until you click "More info":

- Click "More info" in the blue dialog.
- Then click "Run anyway".

Windows protected your PC

Microsoft Defender SmartScreen prevented an unrecognized app from starting. Running this app might put your PC at risk.

More info



Run anyway

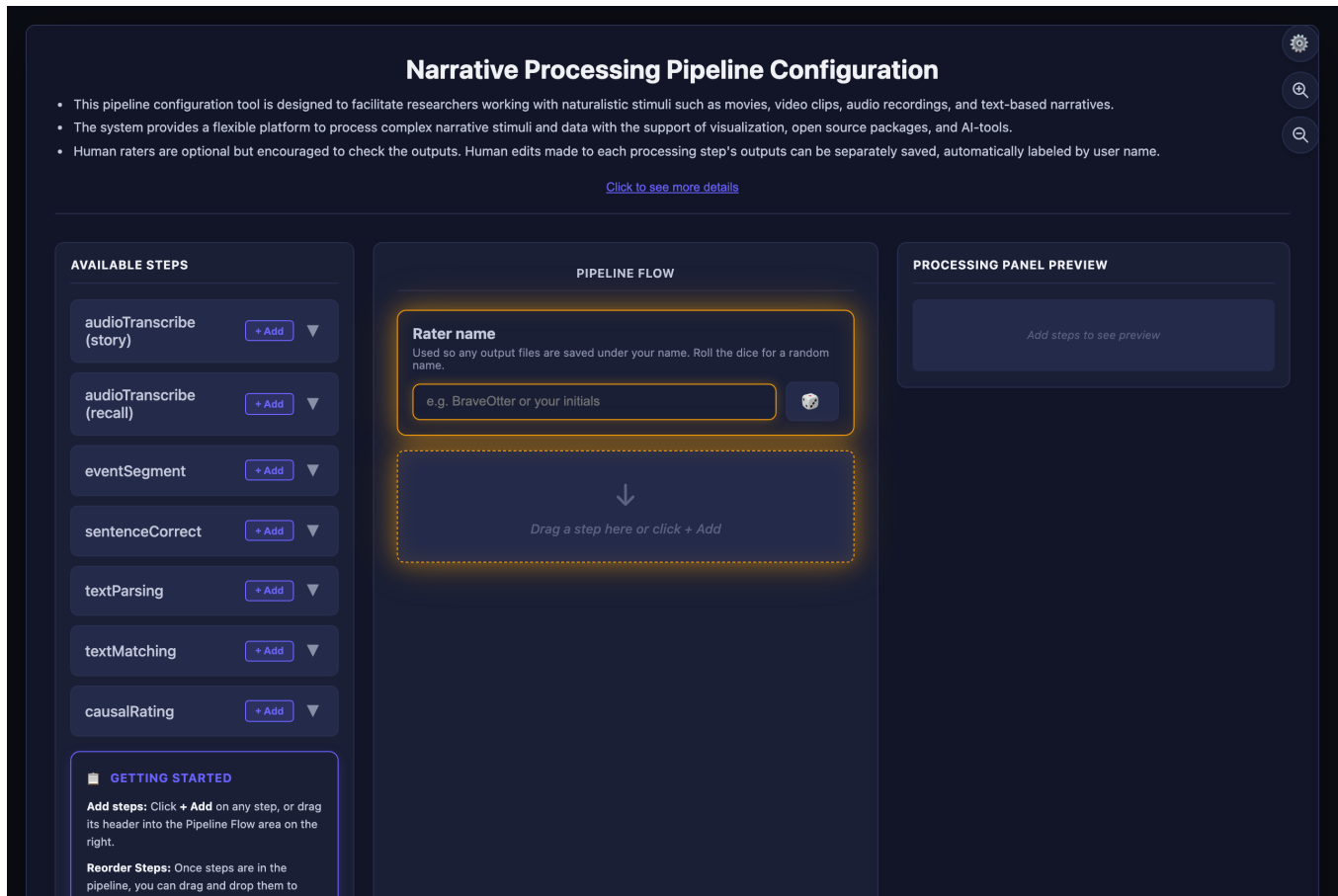
1) Click More info -> 2) Run anyway appears -> click it.

After allowing it once, open the launcher again.

macOS and Windows remember your choice, so future launches open straight away. Return to Step 2 and double-click the launcher one more time.

Success: the Pipeline Configuration page

When the app is running, your browser opens to <http://127.0.0.1:5000/pipeline-config> and shows the screen below. If you see this page, narRater is installed and working. (See a blank page? Visit <http://127.0.0.1:5000/pipeline-config> directly -- an IPv4/IPv6 quirk on some Macs.)



The success screen. Left: available steps. Middle: your pipeline (enter a rater name, then drag in steps). Right: a live preview of the dashboard.

What next

Put your study files under the data/ folder (bundled examples are already there so you can explore right away), then follow [narRater_Tutorial.pdf](#) for a click-by-click tour of building a pipeline, running steps, and reviewing results.

Quick troubleshooting

If you see...	Do this
"Python 3.10+ required"	Install Python 3.10+ from python.org, close and reopen the terminal, then launch again.
Blank page at localhost:5000	Go to http://127.0.0.1:5000/pipeline-config directly (IPv4/IPv6 quirk on some Macs).
Port 5000 already in use	The launcher auto-tries 5001-5010 and prints the URL. On macOS you can also turn off System Settings -> General -> AirDrop & Handoff -> AirPlay Receiver.
macOS: "couldn't find the narRaters project folder"	macOS ran the app from a temporary copy. Run <code>xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine ~/Downloads/narRaters-main</code> (adjust path) and try again.
Windows: SmartScreen keeps warning	Click "More info" -> "Run anyway". This is required once for unsigned software.
Nothing happens on double-click	Open a terminal in the folder and run the launcher directly (bash <code>install.sh</code> on macOS/Linux) to see any error message.

Still stuck? See the Troubleshooting section in README.md, or open an issue at github.com/xianNeuro/narRaters/issues.